

Chapter 76-2

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After work, Xu Qingzhu went straight back to the Xu family home.

Her car followed behind Xu Guangyao's car. When they arrived, she greeted Xu Guangyao.

But Xu Guangyao furrowed his brows slightly: "Why did you come back?"

"What kind of question is that?" Xu Qingzhu walked alongside him. "Can't I come back to my own home?"

Xu Guangyao paused before saying: "If you want to talk about company matters, let's discuss it at the office tomorrow."

"It's not about the company." Xu Qingzhu said: "I just came home to have a meal with you."

Her eyes tilted upward, her tone carrying a hint of displeasure. "Could it be that you don't welcome me?"

Xu Guangyao entered the door. "How could that be?"

Most of the servants in the house had been let go earlier, and only three remained now.

As soon as Xu Qingzhu entered, she asked: "Where's my mom?"

"Madam is in the Buddhist prayer room," a servant answered.

Xu Qingzhu glanced toward the second floor, then changed her shoes and entered the house. The aroma of food was already wafting through the home.

After returning home, Xu Guangyao took off his suit jacket and loosened his tie. Seeing her preoccupied expression, he asked hesitantly: "What do you need to see your mom about?"

Xu Qingzhu said: "Just to chat with my mom."

"It's not about divorcing Liang Shi, is it?" Xu Guangyao suddenly asked.

Xu Qingzhu paused, then smiled and replied using his earlier tone: "How could that be?"

"You'll be promoted to General Manager next week." Xu Guangyao said in a deep voice: "Since you want to do it, I'll hand over the authority to you. I'm getting old and can't keep going. If Liang Shi has no objections, then go ahead—but you need to take care of your health."

Xu Qingzhu pressed her lips together. "Didn't you say we shouldn't discuss business matters at home?"

"I just happened to be free, so I'm mentioning it." Xu Guangyao said: "You're not young anymore, and you know your own health condition. Don't always act recklessly, wanting to do everything, only to ruin your health in the end."

Xu Qingzhu knew these words were for her own good and nodded: "I understand. I'll be more careful in the future."

"You and Liang Shi haven't had any problems, have you?" Xu Guangyao still asked worriedly. "You didn't join Minghui because you want a divorce, did you?"

"No." Xu Qingzhu answered patiently: "There are no problems."

She suddenly felt grateful that her decision back then was the right one.

If she had divorced Liang Shi, coming home would inevitably mean being interrogated about everything, and it would bring a heavy, oppressive atmosphere to this family.

"Ah." Xu Guangyao sighed. "Let's wait until next year. Once you've gotten a handle on the company's operations, I plan to retire. Your mother has been cooped up at home all these years. I want to take her traveling to relax."

"So suddenly?" Xu Qingzhu was surprised. "Didn't you still want to..."

Realizing that what she was about to say might be hurtful, she stopped herself in time.

Before this, Xu Guangyao had been arguing with her in the office, thinking she was still too young, displaying an attitude of being unwilling to hand over power.

At the time, she couldn't figure out whether he was keeping her from joining the company because he was worried about her health, or whether Xu Guangyao simply craved power.

Now it seemed like the former was more likely.

"What did I want?" Xu Guangyao looked at her. "Did you think I was planning to leave the company to Qingya?"

"No..." Xu Qingzhu denied.

She had indeed never thought about that, because for her, joining the company was all about preserving the Sheng family's business.

It was simply that she didn't want Minghui to decline.

"Minghui is yours." Xu Guangyao said: "This has never changed over the years. It's just that your health has been poor, and I once wanted to turn the situation around before handing Minghui over to you. But now it seems you're more capable than I am."

Xu Guangyao had Xu Qingzhu follow him to the study, where he took out their grandfather's testament¹. In the column for Minghui's equity distribution, it clearly stated: Xu Qingzhu 36%, Xu Qingya 10%, Sheng Linlang 3%, Xu Guangyao 2%.

The combined shares of the other three people in this family didn't even equal hers alone. Moreover, it clearly stated that this was to be executed after Xu Qingzhu's graduation, with Xu Guangyao only acting as a custodian.

Minghui had always belonged to Xu Qingzhu from the very beginning.

If she hadn't known about her own origins before, seeing this testament suddenly would have seemed unreasonable. But now that she knew, everything made perfect sense.

Xu Guangyao didn't steer the conversation toward her origins either. He simply said: "Your grandparents always doted on you the most. When they passed away, Qingya had just been born and didn't have much of a bond with them, so they left the most to you. But all these years... I really couldn't feel at ease handing Minghui over to you."

"Don't laugh at me for saying this, but when I first took over Minghui, I got sick several times." Xu Guangyao said: "All-night meetings, overnight business trips, constantly staying up late—it was very, very difficult."

Xu Qingzhu finished reading through the testament before asking: "So why have you changed your mind now?"

Xu Guangyao stared at her. "Isn't this what you wanted?"

Xu Qingzhu: "..."

Before graduation, she had also subtly expressed her desire to join the company. But at that time, in the lingering cold of early spring², she went out for an internship for just one week and caught a severe cold—the kind where she couldn't even get out of bed. Afterward, Xu Guangyao looked at her and said: "Why bother working? Just rest and recuperate at home."

So her internship experience was actually a fake one that Xu Guangyao had arranged from his own company.

She had barely worked a few days at all.

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1. 醫囑 (yī zhǔ) - While this term literally means "medical instructions" or "doctor's orders," in this context it refers to a will or testament left by the grandfather. The author may have used this term loosely or it could be a typo for 遺囑 (yí zhǔ), which means "will" or "testament." ↩
 2. 春寒料峭 (chūn hán liào qiào) - A Chinese idiom describing the biting cold that lingers in early spring, when winter's chill hasn't fully retreated despite the arrival of spring. ↩